

TOP OF THE CHARTS

With a campus in Dubai and initiatives such as an AI programme, IIMA is looking to equip its students with the tools to navigate an uncertain world

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THE INDIAN Institute of Management, Ahmedabad (IIMA), has topped the BT-MDRA India's Best B-Schools rankings. But it is an unenviable position: even though it became a proud winner, it did so with a slender margin relative to the next on the list, had to face many challenges through the year like economic uncertainty due to global conflicts and growth of artificial intelligence (AI), and is staring at a landscape where management education and the nature of companies will be sharply rewritten.

Bharat Bhasker, Director of IIMA, says, "We are in a good shape and trying to keep up with the changing technology, but the pace [of adaptation] has to be enhanced. We have to work doubly hard to catch up and remain relevant to the business environment which is unfolding in front of us."

NEW INITIATIVES

To be sure, IIMA took a host of new initiatives: a one-year MBA programme from Dubai, a blended MBA in business analytics and an AI programme, a restructured syllabus introducing new courses with specific focus on technology and finance, and innovative industry partnerships like the one with Novo

Nordisk to strengthen research on a critical subject like managing the obesity ecosystem.

Professor Bhasker says the Dubai campus has a larger objective of amplifying India's soft power. IIMA believes that Dubai is a global future city with particular focus on AI, finance and tourism. Further, it is easier for the school to reach out to other geographical regions like Africa, Northern Europe and countries that are part of the Commonwealth of Independent States, like Belarus and Azerbaijan.

Despite the current uncertainties in the global economic environment, IIMA achieved 100% placements, with an average salary of ₹34.45 lakh per annum and the highest compensation at ₹1.46 crore. Around 168 firms participated in the placement process. The sectors from where the companies recruited were the traditional ones of consulting, investment banking and fintech, while conglomerates like Adani Enterprises and the Essar Group hired students from the general management MBA category.

RANK-1	INDIAN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT AHMEDABAD
OVERALL SCORE	898.4
PLACEMENT PERFORMANCE	All students placed, with an average salary of ₹34.45 lakh per annum
CAMPUS EXPERIENCE	Spread over 102 acres, the main campus offers a lush green space in the heart of the city
NEW INITIATIVES (DIGITAL/ ENTREPRENEURSHIP)	- Launched a one-year MBA programme in Dubai - It has started a blended MBA in business and analytics - Innovative industry partnerships like with Novo Nordisk to strengthen research on the obesity ecosystem